

SPECTRUM OS

Your everyday operating guide

User Manual | Edition 1.2

26 September 2026

25 module-by-module chapters, worked examples, practical checks and a screenshot reference.

Current Alpha features, including variants and Executive dashboard. New reporting enhancements are not yet included.

Start here

New user? Read Getting started, Company Setup and Backup & Restore first. For physical stock, read Inventory, Stock Movement and Stocktake together. For invoice analysis, start with Reports.

This manual describes the current implementation. It does not treat planned features as available. Illustrations come from a separate demonstration workspace.

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Screenshot reference follows the chapters. Use PDF bookmarks or click a chapter above.

01 Getting started & your data

Spectrum OS is a browser-based business prototype. Use this guide for the working features available on 22 September 2026, including product variants and the optional Executive dashboard.

Before you begin

Choose the browser and site address you will use for daily work. Use a desktop browser for wide stock tables.

Steps

1. To learn safely, select Practise this module in the manual. It opens a separate Practice Workspace with fictional records. Look for the yellow PRACTICE WORKSPACE banner. The normal business sidebar is not a practice area.
2. Open the published Spectrum OS address. The local preview only works while its development server is running on that computer.
3. Start with Settings: save company identity and operating details. Then add locations, markets, products, suppliers and customers.
4. Review any pre-filled example records before using the system for business. Some directories start with demonstration data.
5. Use the left navigation to open a module. Save forms explicitly before leaving. Search within directories to find records.
6. Download a backup after important work and before replacing data. Keep a dated copy outside the browser.

What to know

- Data is stored in this browser for this site address. Chrome, Edge, private windows, localhost ports and the published site have separate records; they do not synchronise.
- Publishing application updates does not upload your local business records. Sharing the site link does not share your records.
- Clearing site data can remove saved records. This prototype has no shared multi-user database or role-based access controls.
- Practice edits persist separately in this browser. Practice backups are labelled and cannot be restored into the business workspace by this version. Use Exit to business manual to leave practice. Do not enter confidential business details into a demonstration.

Worked example

To move work from localhost to the public site: export from the original browser/address, open Backup & Restore at the destination, preview the file and restore it there. Restore replaces destination records; it does not merge them.

02 Dashboard: Classic & Executive

Get an overview and open commonly used modules. Choose the presentation that suits you without changing business data.

Before you begin

Save the underlying directories to populate the Executive dashboard. Sample records that have been saved are included.

Steps

1. Open Dashboard and find Dashboard appearance at the top.
2. Select Executive for the navy sidebar, coloured summary cards, product portfolio, category ring and country breakdowns.
3. Select Classic to return to the original dashboard with quick actions and management alerts.
4. Click a metric or View all button to open its directory. Executive search matches saved names and IDs and opens the relevant directory.
5. Use Analytics for more detailed stock and expiry information.

What to know

- Classic is the default. Your selection is remembered separately in each browser and is not part of the business backup.
- Executive counts saved records, including variants and inactive records. Classic counts current records and can show initial examples before a directory is saved, so totals may differ.
- Executive country coverage is a list/count from recorded countries. It is not a live map. Opportunity scores and trend lines from the original concept are not calculated.

Worked example

Select Executive, refresh, and the same style remains selected. Switching back to Classic restores its layout without altering products or stock.

03 Settings & Company Setup

Maintain company identity, address, registration details, operating defaults and product configuration.

Before you begin

Have your company details ready. Enter business values, not browser autofill suggestions for a person or job title.

Steps

1. Open Settings. In Company Setup, enter Legal Name and optional Trading Name, then choose Business Type, Home Country and Base Currency.
2. Enter the address, city, state/region and postal code. Complete relevant registration fields shown for your setup.
3. Review Operating Defaults: financial-year start, time zone and date format. Save the company profile and check the saved confirmation.
4. In Product Configuration, add categories or statuses as required. Use active/inactive controls to manage choices offered in Products.
5. Return to Locations after saving the company identity. New locations use the company country as their default.

What to know

- Business Type uses a controlled list. Sole Proprietorship is the sole-proprietor option; a duplicate Proprietorship option is not needed.
- These settings record your choices; they do not perform tax registration, currency conversion or establish complete accounting rules.
- Invoice print branding has its own layout editor. Check it separately when company details change.

Worked example

Use your registered company name in Legal Name. A saved suggestion such as Owner/Director belongs to a person's role and should not be accepted as the company name.

04 Products & HSN codes

Maintain product identities used by invoices, research and stock records.

Before you begin

Set up the required categories/statuses in Settings and target markets in Markets.

Steps

1. Open Products and choose Add Product.
2. Check Product ID and enter Product Name. Choose Category, Status and one or more Target Markets.
3. Enter the HSN Code if known. It accepts 4, 6 or 8 digits; leave it blank until classified.
4. Choose Save Product. Use Search Products and the Status filter to find it again.
5. Use Edit for changes to descriptive details. Prefer an inactive status for an item with business history.

What to know

- Product ID cannot be changed after creation. Deletion is blocked where inventory, batches, movements, invoices or child variants depend on the product.
- HSN is a stored classification, not an automatic tax-rate lookup. Invoice lines retain the classification saved with the invoice; changing the master does not rewrite earlier invoices.
- Adding a normal product does not automatically add an inventory row. If it is absent from Stock Movement, stock setup is incomplete; the current normal-product inventory setup workflow needs further development.

Worked example

A product with HSN 012345 keeps its leading zero. Use Product-wise Reports with that HSN to isolate matching invoice lines.

05 Product variants

Create separately stocked sizes, colours or pack options under a parent product.

Before you begin

Save the parent product. Open Inventory once to initialise stock records. Make sure the required location is available.

Steps

1. In Products, click Variants beside the parent. Use Manage variant types to save reusable types (Size, Grade, Pack) and comma-separated values.
2. Choose six or more saved option types as needed; there is no fixed type limit. Tick the values to use, or Select all values. Use these types by default saves the type choices for future setup.
3. Click Preview combinations. Untick unwanted rows. Filter combinations narrows the view; hidden selections remain selected. Use Clear all before selecting only a filtered group.
4. For new products, choose Stock unit and Initial stock location, then Create new variants. Each starts at zero stock; receive or count it separately.
5. To reuse a product, click Link existing beside a combination, search for the product and Save link. This saves that link immediately and closes setup; other unsaved combinations are not created.

What to know

- Preview up to 100 combinations. New products copy category, HSN, status and target markets. Existing combinations cannot be duplicated.
- Linking retains the existing product ID, details, stock and transaction history. A child or a product with children cannot be linked. Parent stock is never redistributed; packs do not automatically convert.
- Saved types are included in backups and separated between practice and business. Editing type values does not alter existing variants. Parent-consolidated reporting and automatic barcode/price inheritance remain planned.

Worked example

Size = 250 ml, 500 ml and Pack = Single, Case produces four combinations. Select only the combinations you actually stock; use a consistent stock unit for this creation batch.

06 Suppliers

Keep supplier identities, primary contacts and physical addresses for purchasing and research.

Before you begin

Have the supplier name, contact, email, city, country and category available.

Steps

1. Open Suppliers and choose Add Supplier.
2. Complete required identity/contact fields and choose the category and status offered by the form.
3. Enter Street / Building Address, State / Region and Postal / PIN Code, plus city and country. Add GST Number where applicable.
4. Save and use the directory search/filters to verify the record.
5. Use Edit to maintain details. Add additional people and follow-up work in Contacts & Follow-ups.

What to know

- Directory status is an internal label; it does not independently verify a supplier or certify a product.
- Supplier records must be saved before they appear in dependent forms such as Purchase Invoices, Packaging and Contacts.
- Keep linked historical records rather than deleting them. Follow any reference warning shown by the application.

Worked example

Keep the supplier company as one directory record, its purchasing contact as the primary contact, and a second technical contact in Contacts & Follow-ups.

07 Customers

Maintain customer identity, contacts, billing information and delivery details.

Before you begin

Gather the customer company name and required contact/billing fields.

Steps

1. Open Customers and choose Add Customer.
2. Enter the company and primary contact details, customer type and status.
3. Complete physical/billing address fields, including street address and postal code; enter delivery details where different.
4. Save the record. Use search and available filters to locate it and Edit to update it.
5. Select the saved customer when creating a Sales Invoice or a contact/follow-up.

What to know

- Unrelated saved address suggestions can come from browser autofill. Replace them with the actual business address before saving.
- A customer record does not create an invoice or schedule an automatic message.
- Check the invoice print preview for the address you expect, especially after changing the directory.

Worked example

Record a head office billing address and a warehouse delivery address separately, so dispatch instructions are not mistaken for the billing location.

08 Contacts & Follow-ups

Maintain multiple people at a customer/supplier and a dated list of actions.

Before you begin

Save the company in Customers or Suppliers first.

Steps

1. Open Contacts & Follow-ups. On Contacts, add a person and select Directory and Company.
2. Enter Full Name, Role / Job Title, email/phone, status and notes. Save.
3. On Follow-ups, create an action for the company and optionally select a contact belonging to it.
4. Enter Next Action / Title, Activity Type, Due Date and preparation notes. Save and review Open or Overdue work.
5. After completing the action, edit it to Completed and enter an Outcome. Use Cancelled where the action is no longer needed.

What to know

- This is a local work list. No calls, emails, reminders or notifications are sent automatically.
- Marking a contact inactive preserves the record. Completing a follow-up requires an outcome.
- Search by person, company or notes; task status filters include Open, Overdue, Completed, Cancelled and All.

Worked example

Create "Request revised quotation" for a supplier, due Friday. After calling outside the OS, record the response and complete the follow-up.

09 Markets

Describe target countries, territories, channels, priorities and trading currencies.

Before you begin

Review the company home country; it is used for domestic/export classification.

Steps

1. Open Markets and choose Add Market.
2. Enter Market Name, Country and Region / Territory.
3. Choose Primary Channel, Priority, Default Trading Currency, any Additional Accepted Currencies and Status.
4. Save the market. Use Search Markets, Classification and Status filters to review coverage.
5. Use the market as a product target or link research findings through Intelligence.

What to know

- A market entry is planning information. It does not approve exports, confirm demand or perform compliance checks.
- Accepted currencies describe trading options; totals in reports remain separated by currency.
- Country lists and labels should be used consistently to keep dashboard country counts meaningful.

Worked example

Create a named New Zealand wholesale market with NZD as its default trading currency, then attach market research with source links.

10 Locations

Record warehouses, stores, production sites and offices.

Before you begin

Save company identity in Settings. Add Location stays disabled until company setup is ready.

Steps

1. Open Locations and review the company shown at the top.
2. Choose Add Location. Enter Location Name, Location Type, Address, City and Country.
3. Add State / Region and Postal Code where available, then save.
4. Use search and status filters to find a site. Edit its details or status when needed.
5. When creating variants, choose the appropriate initial stock location.

What to know

- The location directory does not implement stock transfers. Existing stock records still carry their own location values.
- Renaming a directory location should not be assumed to rename historical stock or batches. Review existing labels before making a change.
- Do not create a second location merely to correct a spelling variation in an existing one.

Worked example

Create “Main Warehouse” as a Warehouse location and use that same label consistently for new variant stock setup.

11 Inventory & balance interpretation

Review stock on hand, its calculation basis, reorder levels and movement history.

Before you begin

Check that the correct products, units and opening records are present before recording movements.

Steps

1. Open Inventory and locate the product in Stock Overview.
2. Read Stock on Hand together with Balance Source. When a product has any batch records, remaining batch quantities determine its balance.
3. Review Total Batch Stock, Eligible Batch Stock and Expired Stock separately. Stock on hand can include expired stock.
4. For a legacy balance without batches, use Convert Opening Balance only after checking the actual quantity and batch details.
5. Where a batch balance is already authoritative but a legacy figure remains, review the resolution action and Balance Audit before retiring the legacy figure.

What to know

- Do not add the legacy figure to batch stock. A batch total of zero remains authoritative when batch records exist.
- Opening-balance conversion creates a batch-backed opening record; it is not a routine purchase receipt. Supply dates, batch, location and a meaningful reason.
- Quantity corrections belong in Stocktake. Units are not automatically converted, and unlike units should never be totalled together.

Worked example

If legacy stock says 100 but batches total 80, the displayed balance uses 80. Investigate the difference rather than receiving another 20 merely to make the figures match.

12 Stock Movement: receipts & issues

Record physical stock entering or leaving inventory.

Before you begin

The product must already have an inventory row. Prepare the movement date, quantity and relevant batch details.

Steps

1. Open Inventory and select Stock Movement. Choose Product, Movement Type and Movement Date.
2. For Stock In, enter positive Quantity, Batch / Lot Number, Manufacturing Date and Expiry Date. Check that dates are valid and batch details agree with existing records.
3. For Stock Out, enter Quantity and choose the Starting Batch / Lot. Review the proposed allocation across eligible batches.
4. If overriding the recommended FEFO order, enter the required reason. Confirm the batch allocation before saving.
5. Save the movement and check both Stock Overview and Stock Movement History. Link it separately to an invoice if appropriate.

What to know

- FEFO means first-expiry-first-out. Expired stock is not treated as freely issueable merely because it contributes to stock on hand.
- Recording an invoice does not create these movements. A receipt or issue must be recorded separately; avoid recording the same physical movement twice.
- Movement Date is the business date. Entered At records when the entry was made.

Worked example

Receive 10 bottles into batch B-SEP, then issue 3 through Stock Out after reviewing allocation. The batch balance becomes 7 bottles; an invoice alone would not make that change.

13 Batch / Lot Register

Track batch identities, manufacturing/expiry dates, locations and balances.

Before you begin

Use the product ID and batch details from the physical stock or supplier documentation.

Steps

1. Open Batch / Lot Register and review the available search/filter controls.
2. Add a batch when its identity must exist before stock work. Enter the product, batch number, dates and location requested.
3. Remember that adding batch metadata starts quantities at zero; record a receipt through Inventory to bring stock in.
4. Use the metadata correction option when a batch number/date/location needs correction, and provide a Correction Reason.
5. Review the audit history after a correction. Use Stocktake for quantity differences.

What to know

- Metadata correction does not serve as a quantity adjustment.
- Creating a zero batch for a product changes the balance basis to batches. Reconcile any legacy opening balance first.
- Batch quantities use the product inventory unit; the batch itself does not define a separate conversion unit.

Worked example

If a supplier document shows the expiry date was typed incorrectly, correct the batch metadata with the documentary reason rather than creating a duplicate batch.

14 Stocktake & variance posting

Compare system stock with physical counts, review differences and post controlled adjustments.

Before you begin

Back up first. Set up missing batches before starting, pause stock movements and close other Inventory/Batch tabs before posting.

Steps

1. Enter a Stocktake name and choose Start Stocktake. The count captures all saved stock rows by batch/location, including zero and expired batches.
2. Enter physical counts. Blank means uncounted, while 0 means no stock counted. Enter a reason for every difference from the captured system quantity.
3. Choose Save Count before leaving. Use Continue Count to resume a saved count. Export Variance CSV or Download Printable Report to review it.
4. If leaving rows uncounted, explicitly choose Keep system quantity for all uncounted items. Alternatively, use the zero-assignment action, give a reason and review all affected rows.
5. Choose Review & Update Stock, read the report, confirm the review checkbox and choose Post Adjustments. The stocktake becomes Posted and is locked.

What to know

- Saving a count does not update stock. Posting changes remaining batch balances or standalone inventory balances and records adjustment movements.
- Assigning zero affects ALL uncounted rows, including rows hidden by search. Those rows are marked assigned zero, not physically verified. Retained rows are also not physically verified.
- A stocktake cannot post twice. If stock changes after the snapshot, posting is blocked: retain the old count for reference, start a new stocktake and recount.

Worked example

System 20, physical 18 gives variance -2. Save a reason such as "Two units damaged and removed". After review/posting, the balance is 18 and a Stocktake Decrease of 2 is recorded.

15 Purchase Invoices

Record supplier invoices, totals, cumulative payments and links to stock receipts.

Before you begin

Save the supplier and products first. Use the supplier document for prices, discounts and tax amounts.

Steps

1. Open Purchase Invoices and add an invoice. Choose Supplier, Supplier Invoice Number, Currency, Invoice Date and Due Date.
2. Add product lines. Enter Unit, Quantity, Unit Price, Discount Amount and Tax Amount for each line.
3. Check calculated subtotal, discount, tax, total and balance. Save as Draft while reviewing.
4. Set Invoice Status to Confirmed when details are correct. Confirmation locks supplier, dates and product amounts.
5. Update Total Amount Paid and payment notes as payments are made elsewhere. Select eligible receipt links where the stock has already been recorded.

What to know

- Discount and tax are AMOUNTS, not percentages. Saving does not change stock or send money.
- Total Amount Paid is cumulative. If another 200 is paid against a previously recorded 300, enter 500, not 200.
- Cancelled invoices require a reason and are locked. Cancellation does not reverse physical stock or payments. Resolve those separately.

Worked example

Quantity 10 x unit price 100 = 1,000. Discount amount 50 and tax amount 171 give invoice total 1,121. Confirm only after comparing with the supplier document.

16 Sales Invoices

Prepare customer invoices and track amounts received without automatically dispatching stock.

Before you begin

Save the customer, physical/billing details, products and HSN codes where available.

Steps

1. Open Sales Invoices and add an invoice. Choose the customer and complete the invoice number, currency and dates shown.
2. Add product lines with unit, quantity, unit price, discount amount and tax amount. Select individual variants when relevant.
3. Review the total and save as Draft until ready. Confirm after checking all details.
4. Record the cumulative amount received and references as receipts occur outside the OS. Link eligible Stock Out movements separately.
5. Open the print view, review branding/address/HSN details and print or save as PDF.

What to know

- Confirmation locks the core invoice details. It does not dispatch stock, send an email or collect payment.
- Invoice totals use the entered amounts; the OS does not infer a tax rate from HSN.
- A cancelled record remains part of history. Stock returns and money refunds are not created automatically.

Worked example

Sell 4 of the 250 ml variant on an invoice, then record a separate Stock Out of 4 from its eligible batch. Link that dispatch so the invoice and movement can be cross-referenced.

17 Invoice printing, logo & layout

Personalise the printable invoice header and footer while retaining the calculated invoice content.

Before you begin

Open an existing invoice print preview. Prepare a PNG, JPEG or WebP logo under 500 KB.

Steps

1. In the print preview choose Edit Layout / Add Logo.
2. Upload Logo and choose Left or Right position. Select the Accent Colour.
3. Complete the available heading, company, address, contact, registration, additional-details and footer fields.
4. Choose Save Layout, then review the invoice preview for addresses, line wrapping, HSN, totals and page breaks.
5. Use the print controls to print or save a PDF. If the embedded browser cannot print, open the preview/printable copy in an external browser.

What to know

- This is a structured layout editor, not a free-form document designer. It does not alter invoice quantities or amounts.
- Layout is saved in this browser and included in the business backup. Check both sales and purchase previews after changing shared branding.
- Typed additional details/footer text is literal content; do not assume an unlisted placeholder will automatically populate.

Worked example

Place the company logo at left, enter bank/remittance details in the appropriate free-text area, and add payment terms in the footer. Check the preview before sending it.

18 Reports: sales, purchases & balances

Generate invoice-based registers, party/product summaries, monthly summaries and outstanding balances.

Before you begin

Save invoices first. The default invoice status is Confirmed, so drafts do not appear unless you change it.

Steps

1. Choose Report source: Sales or Purchases. Then choose the register, customer/supplier-wise, product-wise, monthly or outstanding report.
2. Set Invoice date from/to. Search and select Customer/Supplier, Product, Category and HSN as required; clear a field for All.
3. Apply status, payment and currency filters. Outstanding reports add due-date and overdue-age filters and use confirmed invoices with balances.
4. Choose Refresh Data after changing invoices elsewhere. Read the filter description and totals before exporting.
5. Use Export CSV, Print / Save PDF or Download Printable Copy. Landscape is recommended for wide reports.

What to know

- Product-wise totals include matching lines only. Other views select invoices containing matching lines and report their whole-invoice totals.
- Category and HSN come from saved invoice classifications; older lines may be Unclassified or Not recorded.
- Balances use payments currently recorded, not balances historically outstanding at the selected end date. Currency, unit and status totals are kept separate where applicable.
- The new inventory report suite, period comparisons and consolidated parent-variant reports are planned next; they are not part of this manual edition.

Worked example

To see one HSN sold to one customer: choose Sales > Product-wise, set the date range, customer and HSN, and optionally select a product. For a supplier, switch to Purchases and select the supplier.

19 Packaging

Maintain specifications for bottles, labels, cartons and other packaging items.

Before you begin

Prepare a clear specification with capacity/dimensions and units. Save a supplier first if linking one.

Steps

1. Open Packaging and choose Add Packaging.
2. Enter a distinct Packaging Name, choose Packaging Type and enter Material.
3. Enter Specification, including units, capacity and dimensions. Choose Unit of Measure and Status.
4. Optionally select Supplier, then save.
5. Use Search Packaging and Status to find records. Edit details when the specification changes.

What to know

- The supplier link does not imply approval of either supplier or packaging.
- This directory does not automatically deduct packaging when products are sold or manufactured.
- A packaging master item and a product pack-size variant are different records with different purposes.

Worked example

“Amber glass bottle 250 mL” can hold the packaging specification, while “Avocado Oil - Size: 250 ml” is the separately stocked finished-product variant.

20 Intelligence & research

Store findings against products, suppliers, customers, markets or packaging with their source and date.

Before you begin

Save the linked master record first. Collect a source URL for a sourced fact.

Steps

1. Open Intelligence and choose Add Research.
2. Enter Title, Finding Type, Research Date and Finding Summary.
3. For Sourced fact, supply an HTTP/HTTPS Source URL. For Assumption, a source is optional.
4. Select Linked Module and Linked Record, then Save Research.
5. Search or filter by module/status. Archive outdated findings; use Restore to return an archived entry to the current list.

What to know

- Sourced fact means a citation was recorded, not that the finding was independently verified.
- This register does not automatically research websites, refresh source information or score opportunities.
- The AI Assistant view is a placeholder and is not connected to an operational assistant.

Worked example

Record a supplier's stated certification with its public source and research date. Keep your own unverified capacity estimate as an Assumption instead.

21 Analytics

Review stock exposure, directory status counts and research coverage from saved browser records.

Before you begin

Open/save the source modules. Initialise both Inventory and Batch / Lot Register before expecting stock metrics.

Steps

1. Open Analytics and check the snapshot timestamp and expiry reference date.
2. Select an Expiry Window of 30, 60 or 90 days.
3. Review low-stock rows, expired batches, expiring-soon batches and unknown expiry. Use Stock View to show low stock only.
4. Review Master records by status and Research coverage. Follow module buttons to the underlying records.
5. Choose Refresh Reports after changing source records.

What to know

- Uninitialised or unreadable sources are not treated as zero. Resolve the source issue before relying on totals.
- Stock on hand includes expired batches; it is not necessarily stock that can be issued. Expiry today is included in the window, not counted as already expired.
- Use Reports for invoice-based sales and purchases. Analytics currently focuses on inventory, masters and research, not profit or a complete financial dashboard.

Worked example

Select 60 days to review near-term expiry exposure, then open Batches to inspect the affected lots before planning receipts or dispatches.

22 Equipment & planned features

Understand which screens are placeholders and which workflow additions remain planned.

Before you begin

Treat this as an Alpha prototype; visible menu entries do not always mean a complete operational module.

Steps

1. Open Equipment to see its under-development notice.
2. Do not rely on it for maintenance schedules, equipment capacity or asset records yet.
3. Use Intelligence for supported research links only; equipment research linking is not currently one of the supported modules.
4. Use the existing Contacts & Follow-ups work list for business follow-ups, without assuming automatic notifications.
5. Check the manual revision after future updates before adopting newly added workflows.

What to know

- Equipment and the AI Assistant are placeholders.
- Automatic transfers, pack conversions, inventory costing, gross profit, purchase-order receiving and multi-user synchronisation are not implemented as complete workflows.
- Approved next reports include stock on hand, stock movements, enhanced variance, reorder reporting, sales comparisons and variant summaries. Approval of a plan is not availability in the current release.

Worked example

If you need a maintenance reminder today, this Equipment screen cannot send one. Use an established external reminder tool until that workflow is added.

23 Backup & Restore

Protect saved records and move a complete dataset between browsers or site addresses.

Before you begin

Save open forms first. Choose the source browser/address containing the records you intend to keep.

Steps

1. Open Backup & Restore and choose Download Backup. Check that the JSON file appears in Downloads and keep a dated copy.
2. At the destination, download a backup of its existing data before replacement.
3. Choose Backup File under Restore a backup. Inspect the preview, creation date and Current browser/Backup counts for every dataset.
4. Close other Spectrum OS tabs. Read the replacement checkbox and select it only when the preview is correct.
5. Choose Restore Backup & Reload. The app requests a before-restore download, replaces the dataset and reloads. Check key modules afterward.

What to know

- Restore replaces all included business datasets; it does not merge records. Not initialised in a backup can remove a saved destination dataset.
- Unsaved form changes and the dashboard appearance preference are not included. Backups include private business/contact details; store them appropriately.
- Unsupported/damaged data is rejected. A recovery journal supports rollback after a failed replacement. If recovery cannot finish, stop editing, free storage and reload as instructed.

Worked example

To share your actual records with another authorised user, give them the intended backup through your chosen secure channel. A public site link alone does not transfer records.

24 Troubleshooting & daily routine

Resolve common prototype issues without replacing good data or duplicating transactions.

Before you begin

Note which browser and URL you are using. Download a backup before any planned replacement.

Steps

1. Blank page: refresh once. For a localhost connection error, the local server must be running; the published link is independent of that server.
2. Missing data: check the browser and exact address/port. Do not assume another browser has deleted records; it may have a separate dataset.
3. Dropdown only shows All or no choices: save the source directory, refresh the page/data, and type a name or ID in searchable filters. Clear filters to widen the report.
4. Stocktake cannot post again: check whether it is already Posted. Open its variance report. For a missing/stale count, reload and select Continue Count; for changed stock, start a new count.
5. End of day: save drafts/counts, review movements and balances, export a backup and confirm that the downloaded file exists.

What to know

- Browser autofill suggestions are not always application choices. Overwrite unrelated names/addresses and verify the saved record.
- For unsupported backup data, keep the original file. Do not rename fields or clear storage to force an import.
- If a printable dialog is blocked, download the printable copy and open it in an external browser. Refresh the published page after a deployment to load the new application.

Worked example

Before creating a second invoice or posting another stock adjustment because a screen looks stale, refresh and inspect saved history to avoid duplicate business entries.

25 Glossary & workflow checklist

Use consistent terms when reviewing records with colleagues.

Before you begin

All figures in worked examples are illustrative and are not inserted into your business records.

Steps

1. Master record: a reusable product, party, market or location identity. Variant: an individual product linked to a parent, with its own stock.
2. Batch/lot: a traceable stock grouping. FEFO: first-expiry-first-out. Stock on hand: the system balance, which may include expired stock.
3. Draft: editable work in progress. Confirmed invoice: core details locked. Posted stocktake: completed, locked stock adjustment.
4. Variance: entered count minus captured system quantity. Uncounted: blank, not zero. Retained: uncounted system quantity kept with explicit choice.
5. HSN: recorded product classification. Cumulative paid/received: total entered to date, not the latest instalment. Snapshot: data captured at a point in time.

What to know

- Receipt workflow: supplier/product setup -> Stock In for physical receipt -> purchase invoice -> receipt link -> cumulative payment tracking.
- Dispatch workflow: customer/product setup -> sales invoice -> Stock Out with allocation -> dispatch link -> cumulative receipt tracking.
- Reconciliation workflow: backup -> pause movements -> start count -> enter counts/reasons -> save -> review/export -> post once -> verify -> backup.

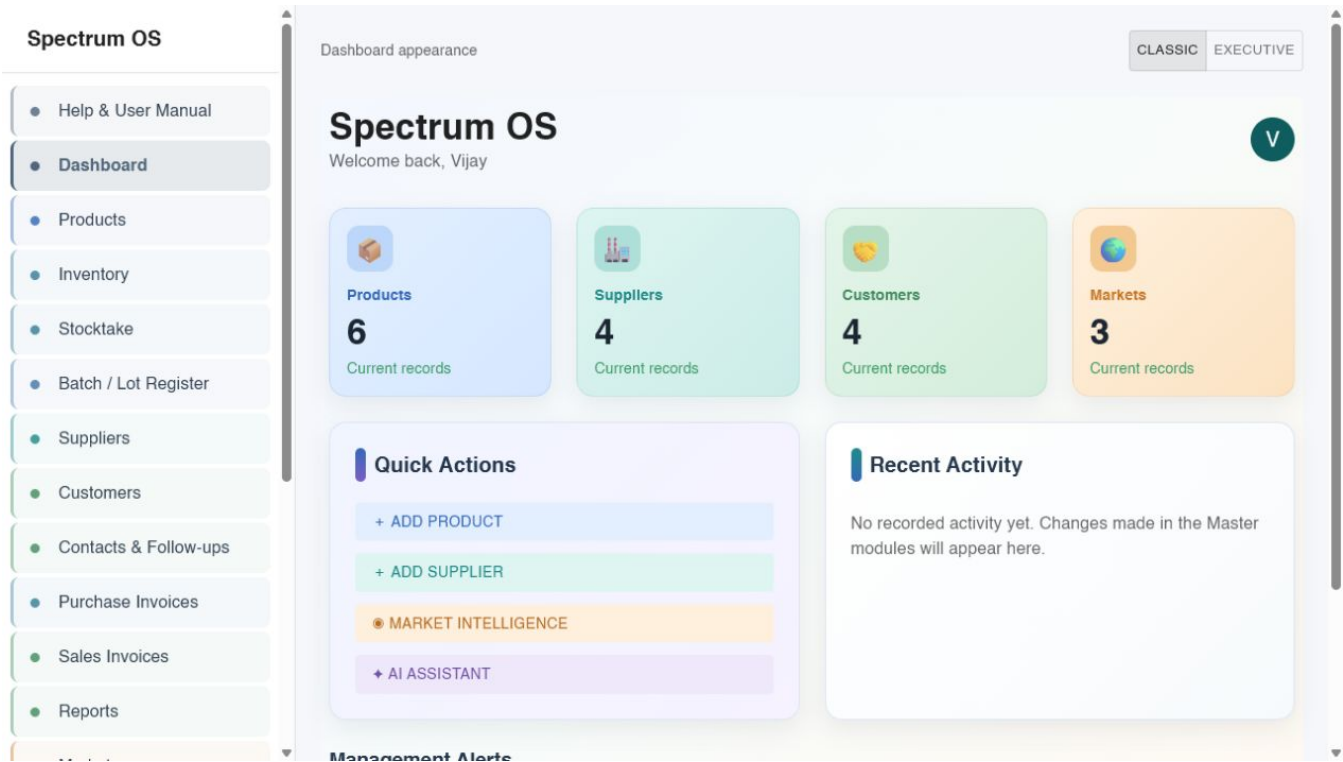
Worked example

When colleagues say “saved”, clarify whether they mean a saved draft, a confirmed invoice or a posted stocktake. Only the last of those directly adjusts stock in the count workflow.

Screenshot reference

Dashboard navigation and appearance

Demonstration workspace - your records and figures will differ.

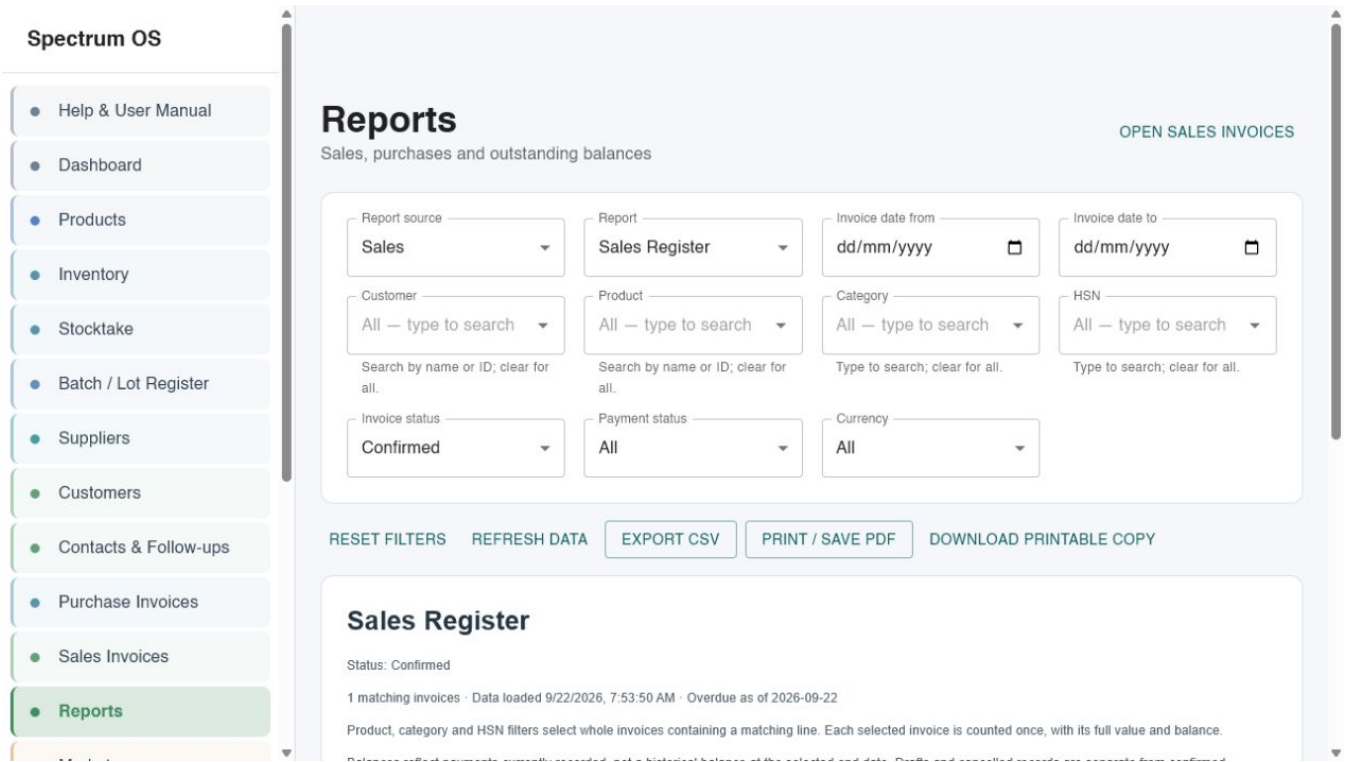


Use Classic / Executive at the top. Cards open the underlying directories. The illustration shows the Classic dashboard and saved demonstration records.

Screenshot reference

Report controls

Demonstration workspace - your records and figures will differ.



Start with source and report type, then combine date, party, product, category and HSN filters. The report explains whether its totals include matching lines or whole invoices.

Screenshot reference

Posted stocktake variance

Demonstration workspace - your records and figures will differ.

Spectrum OS

● Help & User Manual

● Dashboard

● Products

● Inventory

● Stocktake

● Batch / Lot Register

● Suppliers

● Customers

● Contacts & Follow-ups

● Purchase Invoices

● Sales Invoices

● Reports

Stocktake

OPEN INVENTORY

Count physical stock, review the variance, then update stock levels.

ⓘ Each count captures all saved stock by batch and location, including expired and zero-balance batches. Products without batches use their inventory balance. Set up any missing batch in the Batch / Lot Register before starting. Pause stock movements while counting.

BACK TO STOCKTAKES

EXPORT VARIANCE CSV

DOWNLOAD PRINTABLE REPORT

QA stock count · Posted

3 of 3 quantities entered · 1 variances. Positive = surplus; negative = shortage. Quantities use each row's unit.

Variance report · QA stock count

Posted 9/20/2026, 2:50:05 PM · Started 9/20/2026, 2:49:53 PM

Product	Batch	Location	Unit	System	Physical / assigned	Variance	Reason	Count status
Avocado Oil · PRD-001	Unbatched	Main Warehouse	Litres	120	118	-2	QA physical shortage	Physically counted
Zero Sugar Condensed Milk · PRD-002	Unbatched	Main Warehouse	Units	35	35	0		Physically counted
Freeze-Dried Guacamole · PRD-	Unbatched	Finished	Packs	80	80	0		Physically

A completed count shows the captured system quantity, entered quantity, variance, reason and count status. A Posted count is locked; use its report for review rather than posting it again.

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